



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Palm Beach Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.pbchristianacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Palm Beach Christian Academy (PBCA) presents itself as a distinctly Christian, classical education provider operating cradle-to-8th-grade with multiple Palm Beach-area campuses. Public-facing materials repeatedly couple faith formation with classical pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; memory work; and liturgical/community practices such as chapel). The school frames its mission around character formation, virtue, and a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty within a community of families, students, and church partners. Evidence from PBCA materials shows explicit commitments to Scripture-centered instruction, Christ-centered values, and communal practices (e.g., chapels and worship) alongside a Trivium-based curriculum and Socratic dialogue. The presence of Great Books, Socratic discussion, and rhetoric training under a Christian framework aligns PBCA with classical education norms. PBCA's public materials emphasize community partnership with parents and churches (Distinctively Community; partnerships with Family Church; Plan A Visit; campus networks), supporting a strong classical-leaning model in the school's public presentation.

Overall classification by the classical rubric (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School) is: CLASSICAL.

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL. PBCA foregrounds Distinctively Christian identity, Scripture-centered instruction, Christ-centered formation, and liturgical/community worship practices (chapel, worship teams). The site promotes liturgical and communal rhythms (chapel, recitals, worship) and situates education within a faith community anchored to Scripture. Evidence includes explicit statements of faith-centered education and liturgical elements. See: Distinctively Christian / Scripture at center; chapel and worship components; First Baptist/Families church alignment.
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL. PBCA presents education as formation of virtue, character, and wisdom rooted in Christian truth. The materials emphasize virtue, character formation, biblical truth, and formation rather than purely informational aims (with some references to college preparation as a downstream benefit). The combination of virtue/character formation with pursuit of truth aligns with the classical aim.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL. The school identifies a liberal-arts progression via grammar, logic, and rhetoric (Trivium), integrates Great Books and Socratic dialogue, and emphasizes history-informed inquiry. Campus program naming (Grammar School, Logic School) and explicit mentions of Great Books and Socratic dialogue support the curricular criteria.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy / Teaching Methods): CLASSICAL. Pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue and rhetoric in upper levels, with opportunities for seminars, debates, and public speaking; lower levels emphasize contemplative memory and chant-like routines (via liturgical/community rhythms, recitals, and singing). The Conservatory and chapel elements further illustrate memory, chant, and communal forms of pedagogy.
- Element 5 (Faculty): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. PBCA presents a public-facing faculty/storyline and a "Meet the Team" structure, with administrators and teachers listed. However, explicit articulations of the faculty as "the living curriculum" or as mentors who embody the classical cardinal virtues are

less directly stated in the public materials. The available evidence shows a strong faculty presence and Christ-centered staffing, but without explicit language positioning faculty as the primary “living curriculum.” This yields a nuanced, mostly classical impression but not a fully explicit articulation of the “living curriculum” concept.

- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL. PBCA foregrounds a strong community ethos (Distinctively Community) and explicit partnership with parents as co-participants in education; campus networks and plan-for-visits indicate openness and parental involvement. The site promotes parent collaboration, community partnerships, and opportunities for parents to engage with classical education concepts (e.g., plan visits, programs, and community events).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Distinctively Christian identity; Scripture-centered instruction; liturgical/community practices; church partnership context.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Scripture, Christ-centered, liturgical, worship, sacred tradition; no clear negative indicators in the public materials. Positive keyword presence is high; negative keywords are absent.
 - Why this rating: Clear theological grounding, liturgical rhythm, and Christ-centered formation align with classical religious foundations.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Formation of virtue and wisdom; character formation; pursuit of truth; formation-focused framing.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtue, character, formation, truth, wisdom; negative keywords (e.g., job-centric aims) are not evidenced in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The school centers virtue and formation in its messaging, aligning with classical aims beyond pure job preparation.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books and Socratic dialogue; multi-age classical progression; history-oriented pedagogy implied across program structure.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Socratic dialogue, Great Conversation; minimal direct negative indicators.
 - Why this rating: Central features of classical curriculum are present in public materials.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Socratic discussion and rhetoric emphasis; upper-level seminars/debates; lower-level memory/recall and communal singing/chanting; chapel-based memory routines; classical pedagogy in multiple programs.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic dialogue, great books, memory, wonder, rhetoric; PBCA also highlights singing/recital and chapel as pedagogy-supported experiences. Negative keywords absent.
 - Why this rating: The combination of Socratic method, rhetoric training, and memory-based learning aligns strongly with classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public-facing “Meet the Team” and school leadership roles; formal staff affiliations; limited explicit articulation that faculty are the living curriculum.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers, mentors, and staff presence; negative indicators (explicit living-curriculum language) are not evident in the public materials. The absence of explicit living-curriculum framing reduces to SOMEWHAT rather than CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: Strong faculty presence and Christ-centered staff; however, a missing explicit articulation of faculty as the living curriculum lowers to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Distinctively Community; parent-school partnerships; openness to visits; multiple cam-

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- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include “parents,” “community,” “co-teachers” (as a concept in classical education), “partnership with families and churches”; no explicit negative indicators.
 - Why this rating: Strong emphasis on parent partnerships and community integration matches classical expectations for engaged parental/community involvement.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school exhibits robust classical elements across Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Community/Parents. Element 5 (Faculty) is the only area with a nuanced interpretation (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) due to limited explicit language about the faculty being the living curriculum, even though it shows a solid faculty presence and Christ-centered staff. Taken together, PBCA aligns with CLASSICAL education in its public-facing materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 5 (Faculty): Explicitly articulate and publish language that the faculty are the living curriculum, model virtue and formation, and function as mentors who embody the classical aims (e.g., “Our faculty are the living curriculum, modeling virtue, wisdom, and scholarly inquiry in every interaction with students.”). This would strengthen Element 5 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- For Element 1 (Religious Foundations): Consider adding explicit liturgical/communal routines in more disciplines beyond chapel (e.g., periodic liturgical readings in humanities or theology-integrated history modules) to deepen the liturgical dimension.
- For Element 2 (Purpose/Goal): While formation is present, a more explicit statement contrasting formation with information and job-readiness could further align messaging with the full formation-through-wisdom objective highlighted by classical education.
- For Element 3 (Curriculum): The site could further emphasize history as a through-line across the curriculum (not merely as a separate course) to strengthen the “history through the curriculum” criterion.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Continue to document and showcase examples of upper-level seminars, debates, and formal rhetoric assessments to provide richer public evidence of Socratic/seminar pedagogy in practice.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Maintain and expand opportunities for parent learning (book studies, readings on classical education) to deepen parental engagement and reinforce the co-teacher role.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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